

Post-Operative Instructions: Frenuloplasty

After the surgery

Patients should expect some mild swelling, pain, and/or discomfort as a normal process of wound healing. Pain is often controlled with over-the-counter pain medications, and other symptoms usually self-resolve over the course of 1 to 2 weeks with proper rest and myofunctional therapy. Possible (but very rare) complications of frenuloplasty may include bleeding, pain, numbness, failure of procedure, scarring, and injury to adjacent structures which may result in salivary gland dysfunction.

Immediately after the surgery

- 1. Bleeding.** It is normal to experience some bloody oozing during the first 1 to 2 days. If steady bleeding occurs, place gauze under the tongue to hold pressure and call our office at (225) 925-2118, or go to your local emergency department.
- 2. Swelling and Inflammation.** It is normal to experience some swelling and inflammation in the first 3 to 5 days after surgery. Your tongue may feel larger than usual and more painful to move. We recommend using Tylenol and Ibuprofen as needed for pain.
- 3. Oral Hygiene.** Please continue brushing teeth as usual. We recommend rinsing with salt water and/or alcohol-free mouthwash several times a day to keep the wound clean and reduce the risk of infection.
- 4. Food and Drink.** During the first few days, you may find it helpful to have soft, cool foods. You may find it challenging to consume hot or spicy foods, or foods that require a lot of chewing.
- 5. Sutures.** We use absorbable sutures that will usually fall off or dissolve on their own within 3 to 5 days and sometimes anywhere from 1 to 10 days after surgery. As the sutures fall out, granulation healing tissue will fill the open wounds. If the granulation tissue overgrows the wound, we recommend brushing the surgical site with a soft brush to remove any oral debris. It is not necessary to completely remove the granulation tissue. As the granulation tissue heals, this tissue will begin to contract by around day 5 to 7. This is when the myofunctional therapy exercises become the most important.
- 6. Myofunctional Therapy Exercises.** We recommend that you rest for the first 3 days after your procedure and focus on minimizing your pain. Once the pain is well-controlled, we encourage you to do light movements with your tongue by sticking it up to the front teeth with your mouth wide open, side to side inside the cheek, around the teeth, and suction hold. Avoid sticking your tongue out during the first 5 to 7 days and begin these more advanced exercises only once you have been cleared by your myofunctional therapist. It is extremely important to perform the stretches and exercises as prescribed by your therapist to obtain the most optimal results.
- 7. Wound Stretches.** Wound stretches are only recommended for wounds that are left open to heal by secondary intention, or if the patient is unable to comply with the myofunctional therapy exercises with maximum efficacy due to pain or contraction. Wound stretches involve wrapping the tongue in a paper towel or gauze, and pulling the tongue outwards, downwards, upwards, and to each side, to feel a stretch for 10 second holds.

8. Lip and Buccal Ties. We recommend that you take it easy for the first few days. Afterwards, run your tongue around the oral vestibule several times a day. We also recommend air puffs. After one week, you can do lift stretching and manual intraoral massage.

9. Physical Therapy. Many patients benefit from fascia physical therapy, craniosacral therapy, osteopathic manipulation, and other forms of physical therapy post-operatively depending on the clinical circumstance.

Call our office at once if you have any of the following

- Severe pain that does not improve with medication
- Bleeding that does not subside
- Severe swelling at the site of surgery
- **Difficulty breathing**
- Fever higher than 101 degrees F (about 38 C)

Call (225) 925-2118. For emergencies, call 911 or contact your emergency department.

Questions or concerns, call (225) 925-2118. After hours or on weekends, leave a message and someone will return your call shortly. For a medical emergency, including difficulty breathing, call 911 or go to your nearest emergency department.

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